

Part 1 — Vocabulary Reference

Study these 8 terms. Each term appears in the exercises below. Cover the Meaning column and test yourself before moving on.

Term	IPA	Meaning	Example Sentence
Chief Complaint noun phrase	/tʃi:f kəm'pleɪnt/	The primary reason a patient seeks care	<i>His chief complaint is chest pain.</i>
Triage verb / noun	/ˈtri:ɑ:ʒ/	To prioritise patients by severity of need	<i>We need to triage the waiting room.</i>
Vital Signs (Vitals) noun phrase	/ˈvaɪtəl saɪnz/	Pulse, temperature, respiration, blood pressure	<i>Please take the patient's vitals every four hours.</i>
Medical History noun phrase	/ˈmedɪkəl 'hɪstri/	Record of past illnesses and treatments	<i>Does the patient have any relevant medical history?</i>
Nil by Mouth (NBM) adjective	/nɪl baɪ maʊθ/	Nothing to eat or drink (US: NPO)	<i>The patient is NBM until after the surgery.</i>
Handoff / Handover noun / verb	/ˈhændɒf/	Transfer of patient care between nurses	<i>I will give you the handover for bed four.</i>
Onset noun	/ˈɒnset/	The start or beginning of a symptom	<i>What was the onset of the chest pain?</i>
Discharge noun / verb	/ˈdɪstʃɑ:dʒ/	Official release of a patient from hospital	<i>The doctor will discharge him tomorrow morning.</i>

Part 2 — The SBAR Handoff Method

SBAR is the standard handoff framework used in UK NHS wards and international hospitals. Memorise the four steps and the sentence starters.

	Step	Your sentence starter
S	Situation	<i>I am handing over [patient] in bed [X]. Chief complaint is...</i>
B	Background	<i>He/She has a medical history of... Current medications include...</i>
A	Assessment	<i>Latest vitals are... The patient is currently reporting...</i>
R	Recommendation	<i>He/She is nil by mouth for... Please monitor... and call if...</i>

Part 3 — Fill in the Blank

Complete each sentence with the correct term from the vocabulary list above. Answers are at the bottom of this page.

#	Sentence
1	The patient's _____ is shortness of breath.
2	We need to _____ the patients in the waiting room.
3	Please take the patient's _____ every four hours.
4	The patient is _____ until after the surgery.
5	I will give you the _____ for bed four.
6	What was the _____ of the chest pain?
7	Does the patient have any relevant _____?
8	The doctor will _____ him tomorrow morning.

Part 4 — Match the Term to Its Meaning

Draw a line or write the letter of the correct definition next to each term. Not all definitions will be used.

1. Chief Complaint	A. Transfer of patient care between nurses
2. Triage	B. Start of a symptom
3. Handover	C. Primary reason a patient seeks care
4. Onset	D. Prioritise patients by severity
5. Nil by Mouth	E. Nothing to eat or drink

Part 5 — Scenario Practice: Complete the Handoff Dialogue

Fill in each blank with the correct term. This is the SBAR handoff from the lesson. Read it aloud after completing it.

#	Dialogue line
1	Nurse A: I'm handing over Mr. Okafor in bed 6. His _____ is chest pain.
2	Nurse A: He has a _____ of hypertension and type 2 diabetes.
3	Nurse A: His _____ are stable — BP 130/85, pulse 78.
4	Nurse A: He is _____ ahead of his procedure this afternoon.
5	Nurse B: Understood. What was the _____ of the chest pain?
6	Nurse A: About three hours ago. I'll complete the written _____ now.

Answer Key

Part 3	1.	chief complaint	2.	triage	
	3.	vital signs / vitals	4.	nil by mouth / NBM	
	5.	handover / handoff	6.	onset	
	7.	medical history	8.	discharge	
Part 4		1. Chief Complaint → Primary reason a patient seeks care 2. Triage → Prioritise patients by severity 3. Handover → Transfer of patient care between nurses		4. Onset → Start of a symptom 5. Nil by Mouth → Nothing to eat or drink	
Part 5	1.	chief complaint	2.	medical history	
	3.	vital signs / vitals	4.	nil by mouth / NBM	
	5.	onset	6.	handover	